

**First Congregational Church of Los Angeles**  
**Pentecost 10**  
*Another Kind of Freedom ~ Kin-dom Economics*  
**9 August 2026**

*LVF Updated 12pm Monday*  
**COMMUNION**

**Preaching: ML**  
**Worship Leading: Cynthia Siadat & LVF**

**Dr. Jaebon Hwang- guest organist**

*[Grace will need her bells table, and Piano needed for Offertory anthem, amplified]*

**Organ Prelude-Concert**

*Passacaglia in C Minor, BWV 582, Johann Sebastian Bach (1685-1750)*  
*Pastorale on "Bunessan", Jaebon Hwang (b. 1982)*  
*Trio on "Ash Grove", Jaebon Hwang*  
*Prelude and Fugue in D Major, BWV 532, Johann Sebastian Bach*

Dr. Jaebon Hwang, *Guest Organist*

**Chiming of the Hour**

**[LVF & Cynthia center chancel]**

**Welcome**

**LVF**

**Words of Gathering**

**CS & LVF**

Generously. Lavishly. Abundantly.  
God spreads seeds of holy possibility far and wide.  
Who will nurture their potential?  
Who will tend their growth?

The Spirit of Life cries out for co-operation  
so that love may blossom,  
that justice may be a beautiful crop,  
and that courage may grow unencumbered.

On this day, let not the gifts of God be wasted  
but the harvest be plenty.  
Let Divine Life flourish among us  
and may all who long for God  
join the labors of liberation.

May it be so.

*May it be so for all of us!*

*Please stand now, in body or in spirit, for our Hymn of Gathering*

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

**\*Hymn Of Gathering**

*As We Gather at Your Table*

HOLY MANNA

[Big, grand, moving along]

As we gather at your table, as we listen to your word,  
help us know, O God, your presence; let our hearts and minds be stirred.  
Nourish us with sacred story till we claim it as our own;  
teach us through this holy banquet how to make love's victory known.

Turn our worship into witness in the sacrament of life;  
send us forth to love and serve you, bringing peace where there is strife.  
Give us, Christ, your great compassion to forgive as you forgave;  
may we still behold your image in the world you lived to save.

Gracious Spirit, help us summon other guests to share this feast  
where triumphant love will welcome those who had been last and least.  
There no more will envy blind us nor will pride our peace destroy,  
as we join with saints and angels to repeat the sounding joy.

[adapt/cpdawjr]

[Laura center chancel]

**Prayer of Awareness**

**LVF**

Generous God, this gift of life has its source in you. Forgive us for the ways we've  
bought into the world's narratives about wealth and worth. Free us from the grip of materialism  
and the fear of scarcity. Give us wisdom to steward our resources in ways that reflect your heart  
for justice and care for creation. Help us build communities marked by generous sharing rather  
than anxious hoarding. Make us channels of your abundance, trusting that you will provide all  
we truly need.

??

[All turn towards choir]

**Introit**

Let All Things Now Living  
Dr. Fahad Siadat, *Conductor*, Dr. Jaebon Hwang, *Organ*

Traditional Welsh  
arr. Katherine Davis

[Cynthia to lectern]

**\*The Lord's Prayer**

**CS**

**Let us pray together this Lord's Prayer, adapted by enfleshed...**

*Weaver of Life, Ancient and Unfolding,  
How sacred is your Presence!  
We lean on your guidance.  
We seek your love.  
We open to your transformation.  
Provide us bread in body and spirit  
to sustain us in faith and solidarity.  
Companion us with grace  
as we seek to live lives of forgiveness and compassion,  
repair and accountability.  
We remember those who have supported us  
as we seek to support others  
in all the mess and glory of this human journey.  
Guard our minds and hearts from the temptation of domination  
and turn our loyalty away from the systems of evil.  
For the whole cosmos hums with your wisdom.  
Everything that lives, returns to your care.  
Our thanks and honor to you,  
Gracious Web of Existence,  
Our Source and our Home.  
Amen and Amen.*

[enfleshed]

**[All turn towards altar]**

**\*Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,  
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.  
World without end, Amen, Amen.

**[Laura center chancel]**

**\*Passing of the Peace**

**LVF**

**Please join me in these words of peace:**

Though the mystery of God remains beyond grasp,  
the Spirit infuses us with glimpses of justice,  
with touches of love,  
and with whispers of truth.

Always and everywhere,  
the Wisdom of God is being revealed  
that we might live and love differently together -  
free from the ways that destroy.

*Holy Mystery surround us now,  
and reveal the ways of collective liberation.*

This morning may the Peace of God be with you.  
*And also with you!*

*You are invited to share this ancient greeting with a bow*

*Please be seated*

**[Cynthia to lectern]**

**Reading from Our Religious Tradition** *from the Book of Acts* **CS**  
*Hear now this reading from the Book of Acts, chapter 2...*

All who believed were together and had all things in common; they would sell their possessions and goods and distribute the proceeds to all, as any had need. Day by day, as they spent much time together in the temple, they broke bread at home and ate their food with glad and generous hearts, praising God and having the goodwill of all the people.

For the witness and challenge of our ancestors...  
*Thanks be to God!*

**[Jaebon transition Laura to center chancel]**

**Prayers with the People** **LVF**

**Invitation to Silence and Prayer**

**May this time of silence and prayer, offer what your spirit needs  
to evolve, to expand, to unfold.  
May it stretch you, but just enough.  
Not by force or by demand,  
but like an invitation that opens slowly,  
too careful to be rushed....** enfleshed

**[2 minutes Jaebon transition out of silence]**

**Prayer of Our Hearts**

Holy One, you are always and forever with us. You have offered us, and our ancestors before us, your life-giving presence - but we don't always respond to your invitations. The abundance of your world overwhelms us; your faithfulness surrounds us, and yet...we draw back.

You have shown us through Jesus, the humanity you hope can be ours. It all sounds so good God – freedom, justice, peace – but these things ask so much of us! And because we forget to rely on the help you offer through the Spirit of Life, we grow discouraged or

indifferent...too easily. And yet, O God, we do want what you want – a new creation where we shall live, one and all, as one people.

On this day, Holy One, let this kind of newness begin with us – help us to forget what lies behind and turn our hearts and hands to what is ahead. Help us get free from the chains of guilt and self-pity, which stop our energy to love and our ability to *be* loved. Freshen up our hopes and dreams and help us make a new commitment to what lies before us.

And then, O God, bring us to a place, where we can help each other as we share in the mystery of life - and as we share the goodness of you.

*This we pray, creating with you, transforming God!*  
***Amen and Amen.***

**[Jaebon transition for Laude]**

**Meditation Anthem**

Concord  
*Laude*

Benjamin Britten  
Text: William Plomer

*Concord is here our days to bless. And this our land to endue with plenty, peace and happiness.  
Concord. Concord and Time. Each needeth each. The ripest fruit hangs where not one,  
but only two. Only two can reach.*

**[Jaebon transition Michael to pulpit]**

**Sermon**

***Kin-dom Economics***

**ML**

**[Jaebon transition as Michael & Laura go behind communion table]**

**The Eucharist and Blessings**

**LVF & ML**

**Words of Invitation and Remembrance**

We give thanks to God for our life  
And the courage we are given to live it.  
Let our gratitude for life be expressed in our generosity.  
Let our faith be expressed in good causes.  
Let our belief in the future find full expression  
In our daily attitude of mind. [Frances McNab]

We give thanks for the invitation to be at this table,  
For here we are shown our lives...

The daily bread of work and care,  
The cup of delight, pressed from the fruits of creativity  
And our brokenness, with all its pain and self-knowledge.

We celebrate that life is ours  
For we know we are precious in your sight.

We celebrate the life that is yours, pattern of reality for us:  
Life that is love revealed  
Love given and received  
Love in action.

Therefore with all your lovers through the ages  
We praise you, saying:  
Heaven and earth are full of your glory.  
Blessed are those who come in the name of  
Love and Hope.

### **Bread and Fruit of the Vine**

We give thanks for the Spirit of New Life  
Active in our lives  
As it was in the life of Jesus.

At this gathering in this sacred place  
We take bread as Jesus took bread,  
And we remember as Jesus remembered,  
The constant presence  
Of the Spirit of Life and Love.

We break and share this bread  
As Jesus broke and shared it.

We share this bread as our pledge of openness  
To the Spirit in our midst,  
And in acknowledgement  
Of our eternal connectedness with the Spirit of Life.

We take this fruit of the vine and pour it as Jesus poured it.

We drink as Jesus invited the friends to drink,  
Mindful of the relationship of love and trust  
Between ourselves and the Spirit of Life,  
Believing as Jesus believed,  
That beyond pain and shadows and death,  
Life in the Spirit continues  
In ways beyond our imagining.

**LVF: This table is for all, whether you have a lot of faith, etc....**

### **Sharing of the Bread and the Cup**

At this table we celebrate all the diverse ways we have been created. Everyone is invited to share in this feast. This morning we will receive communion with gluten free wafers and grape juice. You are invited to come forward to receive these gifts and then light a candle to signify the

prayers of your heart on this day. As we share this time, we remember that this is the bread of new life and the cup of hope, given in love for each of us.

**[Grace, Fahad, Brandon, Scott help set up the bells table during communion, and piano moved into place after communion]**

**[Cynthia to lectern when all are seated]**

**Invitation to Generosity**

CS

Through our created differences, the Divine Creativity shines.  
Each of us are glimpses of God - just from a different angle.  
So we need not to assimilate, or homogenize unity  
through the erasure of our unique gifts, experiences,  
and struggles - who have brought to this sacred space and time.

As we now give from our time, our talent, our gifts and our money -  
we also give thanks for the beauty, and the wonder,  
and wells of wisdom we bring to this community.

You may our aps....for monetary gifts  
You may also check in at our welcome table at coffee hour today to learn more about  
the ways you can offer your unique gifts and time and talent to this place where we all belong.

**[Choir mics on for the Bells, amp on for the piano]**

**Offertory**

Like a River Glorious

John Mountain

Arr. Christine Anderson & John Carter

Grace Sheldon-Williams, *Bells*, Donald Brown, *Piano*

**[All turn towards altar]**

**\*Doxology**

From all that dwell below the skies,  
let the Creator's praise arise!  
Alleluia! Alleluia!  
Your name shall sound and praises soar  
till suns shall rise and set no more.  
Alleluia! Alleluia!  
Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!

[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

**[Cynthia to lectern]**

**\*Prayer of Offering**

CS

Holy One, through the offering of these gifts

may we become a more open people.  
Help us to be more open-minded in listening for your Word and wisdom,  
open-hearted in working to heal a broken world,  
open-handed in giving to those in need.

*With thanks for all good gifts, we present a portion of our substance  
and the whole of ourselves.*

*We offer this prayer with hope for the freedom of all.  
Amen and Amen!*

*Please be seated*

**[Michael & Laura center chancel]**

**Life at First Church**

**ML & LVF**

**ML:** Summer Clothing Drive is ongoing- bring new or gently used summer clothing items to the security booth anytime! Deadline is this Wednesday. We'll share those with our neighbors as part of Food@First next Sunday, Aug. 16.

**LVF:** Today, our LGBTQ+ group is hosting its second Book Launch following our service in Shatto Chapel.

**ML:** Our Community Collaborative is hosting a Summer Picnic in the Amanda Scott Gardens on Saturday, Aug. 29th!

**LVF:** Next Sunday we continue our summer series with the theme of *Healing Division*. We'll also welcome guest organist, Dr. Emma Whitten. Please join me in thanking Dr. Jaebon Hwang for her three Sundays with us this summer! We hope to see you again soon.

**Words of Blessing**

**ML**

For freedom,  
the Holy One has set us free!  
No longer bound by fear;  
Not tempted towards  
destruction!  
Love is our salvation and  
justice is our cause.  
With the Spirit as our guide,  
We shall not be moved.  
-enfleshed

May it be so.  
*May it be so for all of us!*

**Choral Response**

Dona Nobis Pacem, *from B Minor Mass*

J.S.Bach

Brandon Harris, *Conductor*; Dr. Jaebon Hwang, *Organ*  
*Grant Us Peace*

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

**\*Hymn for the Journey**

***Come, See the Fullness***

**BUNESSAN**

God the Creator gave in abundance all of the wonder we now behold;  
Colors of glory, everyday beauty, echo the story of God's deep love.

Bold as the sunlight, tender as nightfall, love shaped the heav'n's height; love filled the seas.  
Love formed the flowers, called for the living; marked out the hours of time to be.

Come, see the fullness – Life we've been given; beauty and promise, myst'r'y and hope.  
Laughter and weeping, vision and purpose; friends for the keeping, strength for the road.

Open your hearts wide, teach us your wisdom lest our days pass by empty and small.  
May we be witness with your creation – to your great kindness given to all.

[Laura center chancel]

**Postlude**

*Fugue in G Major, "Gigue", BWV 577, Johann Sebastian Bach*

Dr. Jaebon Hwang, *Guest Organist*

### **Inside The Music- Dr. Ianthe Marini**

Today marks the beginning of a transition in the life of our church as Dr. Fahad Siadat and I begin our roles as Co-Interim Directors of Music & Arts at the Cathedral. Within the framework of the church, I am still in my current interim role with First Kids First as Claire Kelly continues her maternity leave, as I help to organize and plan music from afar, joining the chancel again in September. On the chancel today is the beautiful reflection of collaborative efforts of community as we march on with Grace and Don on the bells and piano, both Fahad and Brandon at the choir's helm, our guest organist Dr. Hwang while Christoph continues his much deserved time at home, and the ever-present solid foundation of our choir of professionals and faithfully committed volunteers in singing leadership. I felt that this tangible and active definition of the term *co-operation* was especially apropos to the theme of the day: *Kin-dom Economics*.

It is for this reason that I have centralized one of my favorite poems as the Meditation Anthem: William Plomer's *Concord* which simply states, "*Concord and Time, each needeth each. The ripest fruit hangs where not one, but only two can reach.*" And isn't this the economic structure to which we are called and that which we know most healthfully benefits all? That when *ALL things now living can celebrate in joy and thanksgiving*, as we sing in our introit, we can together enjoy *the river glorious* (as Grace illustrates through bells), and achieve the peace about which we triumphantly and proactively sing in Bach's setting of that urgent imperative—*grant us peace* (in choral response). And in the pursuit of all these things we know: *each needeth each: the ripest fruit hangs where not one, but only two can reach.*

